

LawVM: independent evidence for legislative change

A bounded institutional assurance and pilot brief

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Purpose

LawVM reconstructs legal text through time from amendment sources and exposes the derivation for review. An institution can begin with a bounded, read-only pilot without replacing its drafting, consolidation, or publication systems.

The assurance chain

1. Bind the work to exact source manifestations and identities.
2. Declare the source-effect universe and account for every member.
3. Lower supported effects to typed operations; preserve residuals instead of guessing.
4. Admit operations only under a declared profile and authority boundary.
5. Compare declared writes with independently observed before/after mutation on wired lanes.
6. Construct point-in-time state with explicit temporal and identity rules.
7. Return evidence that a reviewer can reproduce, challenge, qualify, or reject.

Each step has a separate claim ceiling. LawVM does not turn source identity into source correctness, typed closure into legal interpretation, or one confirmed case into a jurisdiction-wide accuracy claim.

Four bounded starting points

Question	Declared input	Return
Does a consolidation follow from amendments?	One source-complete transition set and comparison surface	Source census, replay account, classified differences, evidence packets
Do official-language expressions stay structurally aligned?	Declared expressions, versions, and a bilingual legal reviewer	Availability, pairing, invariant-fact, and residual account
What can be built from our archives?	Representative APIs, XML, HTML, PDFs, scans, registers, and access constraints	Preservation, extraction, blocked-source, and transition-feasibility map
Can we check a transition before publication?	One versioned structured export and declared rules	Read-only target, reference, temporal, language, and mutation checks

Pilot evidence products

- source and scope manifest, including missing and inaccessible sources;
- typed transition account, residuals, and blocked candidates;
- exact source locators, before/after witnesses, and a human review queue;
- review outcomes that distinguish established within scope, qualified, blocked, unresolved, invalid, uncheckable, and not claimed;
- a promotion recommendation stating which checks may remain observational and which could block a shadow result.

Public evidence and current reach

Riigi Teataja reviewed one LawVM-reported omission in Estonia’s Auditors Activities Act and corrected the Estonian consolidation. The public project case record reports a corresponding correction in the English translation; this brief does not present that translation detail as a separately adjudicated public finding. Finland provides a dated replay-construction experiment over the frozen alpha corpus. Other integrated frontends exercise different source and effect models. Japan, South Korea, Poland, and Switzerland remain staging lanes with source-level claim ceilings and explicit next gates.

These are differentiated engineering and evidence profiles, not “supported jurisdiction” badges.

Reliance boundary and next step

LawVM is research software, not an official consolidation, legal advice, legal authority, a certified jurisdiction, or an automatic production-writing system. Do not email confidential or restricted source files; describe the material and access constraints first.

Send the jurisdiction, institutional role, objective, representative sources, bounded corpus or transition family, and local reviewer role to hello@lawvm.org. See lawvm.org/assurance/brief, lawvm.org/pilots, and the [public claim registry](#).